

touch

Sense enabling the skin to detect sensations (contact, heat, pain and others) due to specialized receptors spread widely over the surface of the body.

skin

Outer covering of the body consisting of three layers; it has a role in protection, tactile sensation and thermoregulation.

hair

Threadlike epidermal outgrowth present on almost the entire body having a sebaceous gland and an arrector pili muscle; it plays a protective role.

stratum corneum

Layer of the epidermis consisting of dead cells rich in keratin (the protein that protects the skin); it is shed as a new layer is formed.

stratum lucidum

Layer of the epidermis usually present only in the thick skin of the palms of the hands and soles of the feet.

stratum granulosum

Layer of the epidermis whose cells help to form keratin, which renders the skin impermeable.

stratum basale

Layer of the epidermis whose cells divide and migrate toward the surface to form the upper layers, thus ensuring renewal of the epidermis.

sebaceous gland

Organ connected to a hair follicle secreting a fatty substance (sebum) that lubricates the hair and skin, making them impermeable to air and water.

arrector pili muscle

Muscle attached to a hair follicle and whose contraction raises the hair on end as a result of cold or fear.

nerve fiber

Structure formed of neuron extensions along which the skin's sensory information travels.

hair follicle

Small cavity of the dermis and hypodermis in which the hair root is implanted and which receives secretions from the sebaceous and sweat glands.

apocrine sweat gland

Sweat-secreting organ whose excretory duct opens into the hair follicle.

blood vessel

Membranous canal through which blood circulates in the organism, bringing in oxygen and nutrients and carrying away waste.